

InterviewAce AI

What it is, how to use it, and how it helps you

In one sentence

InterviewAce AI is a free practice tool that scores your resume the way company filtering software does, runs a mock interview using questions built from your own projects, and turns your weak spots into a weekly study plan.

Repository	github.com/Saireddy21072007/InterviewAce-Ai
To run it	Double-click run.bat (Windows) or ./run.sh (Mac/Linux)
You need	Python 3.11+ and Node.js 18+. Nothing else.
Cost to run	Nothing. No API key and no paid service are required.
Course	22AIE301 - Full Stack Development + Applied AI

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1. What is InterviewAce AI?

InterviewAce AI is a website you run on your own computer. It helps you prepare for a job interview by doing three things that normally need a human mentor sitting next to you.

It does this	Which means
Scores your resume	It reads your resume the same way company filtering software does, and gives you a mark out of 100 - with the reason for every point you lost.
Interviews you	It asks you questions out loud, you answer out loud, and it writes down what you said and scores the answer.
Builds you a plan	It turns the weaknesses it measured into a week-by-week study plan that fits the hours you actually have.

You open it in a browser like any other website. The difference is that it runs on your machine, so nothing you upload is sent anywhere.

2. How it helps you

The problem

When you apply for a job and hear nothing back, nobody tells you why. Your resume may have been rejected by software before a person ever opened it. And when an interview goes badly, nobody tells you which part of your answer was weak - you just get a rejection email weeks later, or no reply at all.

Practising alone does not fix this, because the one thing you cannot judge fairly is your own answer.

What changes when you use this

Without it	With InterviewAce AI
You guess whether your resume is good enough.	You see a score out of 100 and exactly which rule cost you each point.
You do not know which skills the job needs that you are missing.	You get a named list of missing required skills for the exact role you want.
You practise answers in your head, where they always sound fine.	You answer out loud and get scored on five separate things.
You know you "need to get better" but not at what.	You are told which of the five is weakest, and given a drill for it.
You study whatever feels urgent.	You get a weekly plan ordered by what is actually blocking you.

The honest version

This will not get you a job by itself. What it does is remove the guesswork: it tells you what a filter would reject, and which specific habit is weakening your answers, so the practice you do is aimed at something real.

3. Getting started

Download or clone the project, then from inside the project folder:

On Windows - double-click run.bat, or type:

```
run.bat
```

On Mac or Linux:

```
./run.sh
```

The first run takes a few minutes because it installs everything it needs. After that it starts in seconds. Two windows will open and stay open - those are the servers. Closing them stops the app.

Address	What it is
http://localhost:5173	The app itself. This is the one you use.
http://localhost:8000/docs	The technical API documentation. You do not need this to use the app.

Other commands:

```
run.bat test    run the automated tests
run.bat stop    stop both servers
```

If the app says it cannot reach the API

One of the two server windows has been closed. Run run.bat again and it will start them both. This is by far the most common problem, and it is not a bug.

4. Using it, step by step

This is the whole journey, in the order you will actually do it. The first time through takes about 20 minutes.

Step 1 - Create your account

1. Open <http://localhost:5173>. You will land on the sign-in page.
2. Click "Create an account".
3. Enter your name, email and a password (at least 8 characters, with a letter and a number).
4. Pick the job role you are aiming for, and your experience level. Both can be changed later, and neither locks you in.

Your account lives only on your computer. The email is just a username - no confirmation email is sent, because there is no mail server involved.

Step 2 - Upload your resume

1. Go to the Resume tab.
2. Drag your resume onto the upload box, or click it to browse. PDF, DOCX and TXT all work, up to 10 MB.
3. It will tell you how many words it read and how many skills it found.
4. Click "Preview parsed text" and read it.

Do not skip step 4

The preview shows you the text the software could actually extract. If it looks empty or scrambled, real company filtering software sees the same mess - which means your resume is being rejected before a human reads it. Usually the cause is a resume exported as a picture rather than as text. Re-export it as a normal PDF and upload again.

Step 3 - Get your ATS score

1. Still on the Resume tab, choose the role you are targeting.
2. Set your experience level.
3. Optional but strongly recommended: paste a real job posting into the job description box.
4. Click "Analyse resume".

You get a score out of 100, a letter grade, and a breakdown showing where every point went. Section 5 of this document explains how to read it.

You can analyse the same resume against as many different roles and postings as you like. Doing that is useful - it shows you which jobs you are actually a fit for.

Step 4 - Set up an interview

1. Go to the Interview tab.
2. Choose which resume to use. Questions get built from it, so leaving this blank gives you generic questions instead of ones about your own projects.
3. Pick the target role.
4. Pick a company style. A service company asks more fundamentals and HR questions; a product startup digs into what you personally built; big tech leans on algorithms and system design.
5. Choose how you want to answer: by voice, by typing, or a coding round.
6. Set the difficulty and how many questions you want. Six is a good first session.
7. Click "Start interview".

Step 5 - Take the interview

One question appears at a time and is read out loud. A timer runs so you can feel how long you are speaking.

1. Click "Start recording" and answer as if a real interviewer asked you. Your words appear on screen as you speak.
2. Click "Stop and submit" when you are done.
3. Your answer is scored straight away and the feedback appears underneath.
4. The next question loads. Carry on until you are finished.
5. Click "Finish and see report".

If you would rather type, click "Type instead" on any question. If you close the tab by accident, reopening the interview brings back the same questions and the answers you had already given.

Answer it like a real interview

The score is only useful if the answer is honest. Aim for 90 to 180 seconds. Say what you did rather than what the team did, and put a number in it wherever you can - "cut loading time from 4 seconds to 1.2" beats "improved performance".

Step 6 - Read your report

1. The report opens automatically when you finish, and lives in the Reports tab afterwards.
2. At the top: your overall score and which of the five dimensions was strongest and weakest.
3. Below that: every question, one by one. Click any of them to open it.
4. Each one shows what you said, your score on all five dimensions with the reason, what a strong answer should have contained, and a model answer.

The most useful part is the "what a strong answer contains" list, with ticks next to the points you actually made. That shows you what you left out, not just that you scored badly.

Step 7 - Build and follow your roadmap

1. Go to the Roadmap tab.
2. Set how many weeks you have before you start applying, and how many hours a week you can genuinely study.
3. Click "Rebuild roadmap".
4. Work through it and tick tasks off as you go. Your progress is saved.

Be honest about the hours. The plan is packed to fit the number you give it, so a number you cannot keep up with produces a plan you will abandon in week one.

Step 8 - Come back and repeat

Take another interview a week later. The Dashboard draws your scores over time, so you can see whether the practice is working rather than just hoping it is.

5. Understanding your ATS score

"ATS" means applicant tracking system - the software companies use to filter resumes before a human reads them. Your score out of 100 is made of five parts.

Part	Points	What it checks	How to raise it
Skill match	40	Do you have the skills this role asks for?	Add real evidence of the missing skills it names. Do not just list them.
Job description match	15	Do you use the same words as the posting?	Where it is genuinely true of your work, use the posting's own wording.
Parseability	15	Can software read your file, and are the expected sections there?	Use clear headings, plain text, and a real PDF rather than a scan.
Impact	15	Do your bullets show results, or just	Start with a strong verb and end

Part	Points	What it checks	How to raise it
		list duties?	with a number.
Fit	15	Do your experience and education match the level?	Give every role clear start and end dates. Add a projects section.

If you do not paste a job posting, that section is skipped and its 15 points are added to skill match - you are never penalised for something you did not provide.

Why the same resume always gets the same score

The score is pure arithmetic, not an AI opinion. That is deliberate: if the number moved by a few points every time you checked, it would be useless. It also means every point can be traced to a rule shown on screen, so you can argue with it.

6. Understanding your interview report

Every answer is scored from 0 to 10 on five separate things. This is the part that tells you what to practise.

Dimension	What a low score means	What to do about it
Relevance	You answered a different question from the one asked.	Repeat the question in your own words before answering.
Depth	You recited a definition instead of showing understanding.	After each answer ask yourself "and why?" twice more, and answer that too.
Structure	The answer wandered with no clear shape.	Use Situation, Task, Action, Result. The Result is what gets remembered.
Specificity	It was vague - no numbers, no named tools, no real example.	Memorise three real numbers for each of your projects.
Clarity	Filler words, rambling, or speaking too fast.	Pause instead of saying "um". Silence sounds like thinking.

The five are weighted differently depending on the question. A "tell me about a time when" answer is judged mostly on structure; a technical question is judged mostly on depth. That is why the same answer can score differently on two questions.

7. Understanding your roadmap

The roadmap is not a list of topics. It is a schedule built to fit the hours you said you have. Tasks are ordered by what is actually holding you back:

Priority	What it is	Why it comes first
Critical	A required skill missing from your resume	Without it you are filtered out before a person sees you.
High	An interview habit you scored badly on	You reach the interview and then lose it in the room.

Priority	What it is	Why it comes first
Medium	A preferred skill you do not have yet	This is what separates you from people who only meet the minimum.

Anything too big for one week is split across several weeks rather than dropped, and empty weeks at the end are removed rather than padded - so the plan you see is the plan that actually fits.

8. Everything it can do

Feature	What it gives you
Accounts	Your own private space. Nobody else can see your resume or answers.
Dashboard	Your scores, your progress over time, and what to work on next.
Resume upload	PDF, DOCX or TXT, plus a preview of what the software actually read.
Resume analyzer	A score out of 100 with the reason for every point.
10 job roles	From frontend and backend to data, ML, AI, DevOps, QA and fresher SDE.
5 company styles	Service company, product startup, big tech, AI team, or generic.
Voice interview	Questions read aloud, answered aloud, transcribed as you speak.
Typed interview	The same interview without a microphone.
Coding round	Coding problems with your solution reviewed automatically.
Reports	Every answer scored, with a model answer to compare against.
Learning roadmap	A weekly plan with links, built from your own gaps.
Admin console	For whoever runs the platform: usage and system health.

9. Questions people ask

Do I need to pay for anything, or get an API key?

No. Everything works with nothing configured. If you do add an API key for a language model, the questions become more personal to your resume and the feedback becomes more detailed - but the app is fully usable without one, and a badge in the header always tells you which mode it is running in.

Does my resume get uploaded to the internet?

No. By default everything runs on your own machine and your files stay in a folder inside the project. If you choose to add an API key, the text of your resume and your answers are then sent to that provider so they can be analysed - that is the trade you are making by turning it on.

Which browser should I use?

Chrome or Edge, if you want to see your words appear live while you speak. Other browsers work fine, but the transcription happens after you stop rather than as you talk. Everything else works everywhere.

The microphone is not working.

Allow microphone access when the browser asks, or via the icon in the address bar. If you would rather not use voice at all, click "Type instead" on any question - answers are scored exactly the same way.

Why is my code not actually run?

Running code that someone else wrote, on a server, safely, requires proper isolation that is a whole project in itself. The shortcut version is a serious security hole. So your solution is reviewed by reading it instead, and the app says so plainly rather than pretending otherwise.

Why is the resume score not done by AI?

Because a score that changes every time you check it is worthless, and because real filtering software is rule-based too. Rules give you the same answer every time and let us show you exactly which rule cost you the points. AI is used where rules are genuinely bad - judging whether a spoken answer had real depth.

Can I use a proper database instead of the built-in one?

Yes. It ships with a file-based database so it runs with no setup. Changing one line in the configuration switches it to PostgreSQL. Nothing else changes.

Where do I report a problem or read more?

The repository has four detailed documents in the docs folder: SETUP.md for installation and configuration, ARCHITECTURE.md for how it is built and why, API.md for every endpoint, and PROJECT_PLAN.md for the plan and current status.

10. About the project

InterviewAce AI was built for the 22AIE301 project, combining full stack development with applied AI. The work splits cleanly between the two halves of the team, and every area maps to its own folder so two people are never editing the same file.

Team	Owns	Folder
CSE Core	Frontend, APIs, authentication, database, deployment	frontend/, backend/
CSE AI	Resume parsing, ATS scoring, question generation, answer evaluation, recommendations	ai/

Built with

Part	Technology
Web app	React 18, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Vite
Server	FastAPI (Python), SQLAlchemy, JWT authentication
Database	SQLite out of the box, PostgreSQL supported
AI	Works offline; optionally Anthropic, OpenAI or Gemini
Speech	Whisper on the server, or the browser's own speech recognition

Part	Technology
Testing	92 automated tests, no internet or API key needed

Current status

All ten planned modules are built and were checked working in a browser end to end. 92 automated tests pass. The project runs fully on a laptop.

It is not yet hosted on the internet. Two things need doing first: uploaded files need proper cloud storage instead of local disk, and the security signing key must be set to a real value. Both are written up in docs/SETUP.md.

Known limitations, stated honestly

- The answer scorer has not been checked against real human interviewers yet. The scoring method is sound, but nobody has measured how closely it agrees with an actual interviewer. That is the honest weak point.
- Code you submit is reviewed by reading it, not by running it.
- Live transcription works in Chrome and Edge only.
- Skill detection works from a list of known skill names, so a skill written very unusually can be missed.
- English only for now.